moving force. Probably, the resource-related and temperamental realities of India got marginalised in hopes and wishes of a future industrialised and developed India. It is yet impossible to conclude whether the economy has completely failed to do so. Experts have divided opinions on this issue.

The last decade of the 20th century (i.e. the decade of 1990s) saw major changes taking place in the world economic idea about the agriculture sector. It was no more a symbol of backwardness for an economy if it had started emphasising its agriculture sector as the engine of growth and development. China had proved to the world that how agriculture could be made the prime moving force of economy and generate internal as well as external strength to emerge as an industrial economy. In the wake of ongoing reform process India was introspecting almost all economic policies it followed since independence. It was time for agriculture sector to have the prime attention. A major shift[10] took place in the Indian economic thinking when the Government announced in 2002 that now onwards, in place of industry, **agriculture will be the prime moving force (PMF)** of the economy. This was a policy shift of historic importance which was announced by the highest economic think tank of the country—the Planning Commission—as the economy commenced the Tenth Plan (2002–07). As per the Planning Commission[11] such a policy shift will solve the three major challenges faced by the economy:

1. Economy will be able to achieve food security with the increase in the agricultural production. Besides, the agricultural surplus will generate exports in the globalising world economy benefiting out of the WTO regime.
2. The challenge of poverty alleviation will be solved to a great extent as the emphasis will make agriculture a higher income-generating occupation and induce growth in the rural economy by generating more gainful employment.
3. The situation of India as an example of ‘market failure’ will cease.[12]

Though the world outlook towards agriculture sector had changed by the early 1990s, the Government of India announced the policy shift more than one decade later. There is now a consensus among the experts, policy-makers and the governments alike that for development to take place in